

FAITH: ENTRUSTING YOURSELF TO CHRIST

More Than Agreeing That the Gospel Is True

Saving faith is the sinner's chosen, life-surrendering trust in Jesus Christ: believing Him, entrusting the whole self to Him, and receiving His rightful authority.



BIG IDEA

Faith believes the Gospel and gives the whole self to the Christ whom it reveals.

KEY SCRIPTURE

John 1:10-13

ALSO READ

Acts 16:25-34

MEMORY VERSE

ACTS 16:31

"Believe on the Lord Jesus Christ, and thou shalt be saved..."

MAIN QUESTION

What Is Saving Faith?

45 MINUTES

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SESSION SNAPSHOT



SESSION GOALS

- Define faith as chosen, trusting surrender to Christ.
- Distinguish knowledge and assent from entrusting the self.
- See that faith receives Christ rather than earning salvation.
- Recognize Christ's rightful authority within saving trust.

A

OPENING ACTIVITY: "WHO HAS THE FINAL WORD?"

1

MAKE FOUR COLUMNS (2 MIN)

Write TRUTH, GUILT, DIRECTION, and FUTURE across the board. Ask who presently has the final word in each area: the self, other people, circumstances, or Christ.

2

DISTINGUISH AGREEMENT (2 MIN)

A person may agree that Jesus is Lord while reserving the right to overrule Him. Agreement recognizes a claim; faith entrusts the self to the One making it.

3

OPEN THE JAILER'S QUESTION (2 MIN)

Read Acts 16:25-34. The answer is not a technique or religious task: 'Believe on the Lord Jesus Christ.' Notice both the Person and His authority.

4

NAME THE WHOLE-SELF TRUST (2 MIN)

Faith places truth, guilt, allegiance, identity, future, and hope in Christ's hands. It does not wait for perfect knowledge or emotion before surrendering.

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LEADER GUARDRAIL

Do not make saving faith depend upon intense emotion, perfect certainty, complete understanding, a prescribed prayer, or a remembered moment. Faith is not meritorious or autonomous; every truth and opportunity is grace. Yet the sinner genuinely trusts: the Spirit does not believe in his place.

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PREPARE

- Bible
- Board or paper
- Four column headings
- Student handouts
- Review Session 9

Saving faith says, 'Because the Gospel is true, I give myself to Christ.'

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B CORE TEACHING

1 FAITH TRUSTS THE CHRIST REVEALED John 3:14-18

Faith is not confidence in confidence or a leap toward an unknown object. The Gospel reveals the crucified and risen Son; faith judges Him true and worthy of reliance.

EMPHASIZE: Saving faith has Jesus Christ as its Person and object.

2 FAITH IS MORE THAN ASSENT John 1:10-13

Knowledge and agreement are necessary, but a person may understand the Gospel and withhold himself. Receiving Christ means moving from 'I see this is true' to 'I entrust myself to Him.'

EMPHASIZE: Faith includes assent and completes it in trust.

3 FAITH GIVES THE WHOLE SELF Rom. 10:8-13

Saving faith entrusts life, allegiance, guilt, identity, future, and hope to Jesus Christ. Calling Him Lord receives His rightful authority rather than preserving autonomous self-rule.

EMPHASIZE: Surrender is faith's personal character, not an added work.

4 FAITH RECEIVES; IT DOES NOT EARN Acts 16:30-34

Faith does not purchase grace or create life by its own power. It receives Christ and what He has accomplished. When the sinner believes, the Spirit joins him to the risen Son and gives life.

EMPHASIZE: The sinner believes; the Spirit gives life.

A ASSENT AND SAVING FAITH

ASSENT

I understand and agree that the Gospel is true.

SAVING FAITH

Because it is true, I entrust my whole self to Christ.

? DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1 Why must faith include knowing the Gospel?

Follow-up: Can you trust a Christ you do not know?

2 Why is agreement alone not saving faith?

Follow-up: What may a person still withhold?

3 What does it mean to believe on the Lord Jesus?

Follow-up: How does His authority belong within trust?

4 What parts of the self does faith entrust to Christ?

Follow-up: Which are hardest to release?

5 Why is faith not a meritorious work?

Follow-up: Who supplies the truth, grace, Christ, and life?

! WEEKLY REFLECTION

Read John 1:10-13 and Romans 10:8-13. Notice the Person received and confessed.

- Where do I still reserve the final word for myself?
- Have I agreed with Christ, or entrusted myself to Him?

+ PRIVATE CONVERSATION

If a student wants to trust Christ, let him address God honestly. No set words can perform surrender; prayer may truthfully express the faith already being exercised.

N LEADER NOTES

- Christ is the object.
- Assent is included, not sufficient.
- Faith is chosen trust.
- Surrender receives authority.
- Faith receives, never earns.

Faith does not merely believe something about Christ; it entrusts the person to Christ.